

Glossary

Here are the meanings of some words it is useful to know when learning about whales and dolphins.

Baleen a black, brushlike material that hangs down from the upper jaw of a baleen (or toothless) whale. It is used for straining krill and plankton from the sea.

Beak the pronounced snout that most whales and dolphins have.

Blow the small cloud of spray produced when a whale surfaces and opens its blowhole.

Blowhole the entrance to a whale's nasal passages, found on top of its head.

Blubber the layer of oily fat under the skin that keeps a whale warm.

Breach a leap performed by a whale when it jumps up from the water and splashes back down.

